

DNS Rebinding for Scraping and Spamming

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Content

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DNS Rebinding for Scraping and Spamming

Okay, last post about DNS Rebinding and then I'll (probably) shut up about it for a while. If you haven't already, please read [posts one](#) and [two](#) for context. As I was thinking about the best possible uses for DNS Rebinding I actually landed on something that is extremely practical for botnets, email scrapers, blog spammers and so on. One of their largest problems for most attackers/spammers is that they need to be able to scrape the search engines for targets and the only way to do that is to send a massive amount of traffic at them and if they use a small subset of machines they are also making themselves easy to block or subvert. Google typically tries to stop robots from scraping by showing a CAPTCHA. Wouldn't it be easier and better if the attacker/spammer could use other people's IP addresses? **That's the promise of DNS Rebinding, now isn't it - unauthenticated cross domain read access from other people's computers.**

[David Ross had a good post](#) about how another practical defense against DNS Rebinding is using SSL/TLS, but since Google has opted not to secure their search engine, it becomes possible to use DNS Rebinding for its next logical use. Google hasn't even fixed [their other SSL/TLS woes](#) so there's pretty much no chance they're going to secure the search engine any time soon. So **DNS Rebinding gives the attacker IP diversity**. An attacker can use DNS Rebinding to get other people to rip tons of information

from Google without Google being able to block the real attacker. Since sites like Google do not respect the host header and they don't use SSL/TLS an attacker can scrape information from these sites all they want - all the while using other people's browsers. Now think comment spamming, polling fraud, brute force, and on and on... All of these become extremely easy and practical by burning other people's IP addresses, instead of the attacker's/spammer's. Yes, DNS Rebinding is nasty, and unless the browser companies do something or every attacked web server on earth starts respecting the host header and/or using SSL/TLS it's a problem that's here to stay.

I know a lot of people think this is a complicated technique, but it's really not that hard. It just requires some JavaScript (similar to [BeEF](#) or [XSS Shell](#)), a place to log data to log whatever the user saw when the attacker forced them to perform the action, a hacked up DNS server (like the [simple DNS Rebinding server sample](#)), a domain, a Firewall that is somehow linked to the attacker/spammer application and some Internet traffic to abuse. None of these things are out of reach for a decently skilled attacker. Anyway, I doubt it's getting fixed anytime soon, which means DNS Rebinding essentially allows nearly free reign for attackers and spammers for the foreseeable future - and no one appears to be doing anything about it.

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